

Chapter 171-5

Amid much anticipation, the show premiered.

As a travel variety show—a relatively uncommon type in the variety market—it brought together a Best Actor, a host, an idol, and an amateur. It was full of highlights.

Especially Bai Yu, who had many fans and many haters, and was inherently controversial.

The production team had invited him precisely to create dramatic moments.

And Bai Yu didn't disappoint. In the very first episode, he clashed with Liang Xinran.

Because Liang Xinran asked him if being on stage was tiring and if he had ever wanted to give up, Bai Yu retorted: "Why don't you try it and find out?"

Liang Xinran's expression immediately changed.

Everyone condemned Bai Yu for his bad temper. Bai Yu's fans: [It's not like this is your first day knowing him.]

Two episodes aired in the first week. Although Bai Yu and Liang Xinran had an unpleasant exchange in the first episode, they were later grouped together for a task, and Liang Xinran helped Bai Yu out of a tight spot.

After she helped him, Bai Yu awkwardly talked to Liang Xinran. Fans edited it into a short video with the caption: The foolish beauty and her tsundere¹ Omega.

Once someone started shipping them, others followed suit, shipping them to death.

The two maintained high popularity, and Liang Xinran and Bai Yu's Weibo accounts interacted to promote each other.

The variety show had a decent opening. The invited guests were quite well-known, so it was considered a minor hit.

Yang Shuyan and Liang Shi appeared at the end of the third episode. In the preview at the end of the second episode, Yang Shuyan was shown, but Liang Shi was pixelated—only her clothes were visible. However, there was a scene of her standing with Bai Yu and Yang Shuyan, leaving suspense. Online, everyone speculated about who it could be.

Some guessed it was Zhao Ying, while others guessed it was one of the CPs who had previously worked with Yang Shuyan.

Opinions varied wildly online.

But Liang Shi didn't have time to deal with any of this. Just filming *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* was exhausting enough. She also took the opportunity to officially announce *Journey of the Heart*.

Gu Yixue posted on Weibo tagging her and Sun Chengcheng, then the *Journey of the Heart* production team released official promotional photos along with copy.

Gu Yixue tagged them all together. The movie's official announcement was done by CP pairing—first her and Sun Chengcheng, then Qi Tang and Tang Zui.

The all-newcomer lineup took everyone by surprise. Some people didn't even know who Gu Yixue was, and the comment section was filled with explanations about Gu Yixue.

Before the official announcement, people didn't quite believe this opportunity was real. But it was about to be released soon, the official photos had just come out, and the movie had already been selected for the Golden Palm's² annual outstanding film.

This was obviously aiming for awards, which raised everyone's expectations to the max.

At the same time, the name Liang Shi trended once again.

Everyone became even more curious about her.

[What exactly is this person's background? How come nothing can be dug up?]

[Which family's heiress is she? Bringing investment to join a project can't even explain this anymore.]

[I really don't understand. Am I the only one who thinks she's just average-looking?]

[...I can understand criticizing her acting, but mocking her looks is unnecessary. She really is one of the top beauties in the industry.]

[Does she even have acting skills? She's only slightly better than Chen Liuying.]

[.....]

The movie hadn't been released, the variety show hadn't aired her episodes, the TV drama hadn't broadcast—yet Liang Shi was already being mocked across the entire internet, criticized until she was full of holes.

Liang Shi was worried Xu Qingzhu would be upset, so she messaged her: [Don't go online these next few days.]

Due to the high filming efficiency, more than half of *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* had been filmed in less than a month.

Liang Shi had also lost a lot of weight, becoming increasingly sharp and capable-looking.

Xu Qingzhu replied: [Too late. I've already seen everything.]

Liang Shi: [...Aren't you just making trouble for yourself for no reason?]

It happened to be evening at that moment. Liang Shi had just finished filming. After the high-intensity shooting, she was actually so tired she didn't even want to move her fingers. She sat in a chair, forcing herself to stay alert while messaging Xu Qingzhu.

Unexpectedly, Xu Qingzhu replied: [Teacher Liang, turn around.]

Liang Shi first sent: [Hm?]

Then she followed her words and turned to look.

Xu Qingzhu was already showing, though it wasn't very obvious yet. She wore a loose long dress to hide her belly, holding milk tea and food in her hands, standing backlit and smiling at her.

Liang Shi immediately got up to greet her. Xu Qingzhu walked toward her and stopped a few steps away, holding out the items.

Liang Shi took them. "Why did you come?"

Xu Qingzhu raised her hand and pinched her tired face, then frowned and complained unhappily, "How did you get thinner again?"

Liang Shi said helplessly, "It's only been one day. You noticed again?"

"Of course." Xu Qingzhu nodded. "Forget one day—I can tell even after just a few hours."

Liang Shi: "....."

"You're just teasing me," Liang Shi said. "I ate a lot today."

Xu Qingzhu sat down with her. "But you haven't eaten with me yet."

"If you wanted to eat, you could have just called me. I could have come over after I finished filming," Liang Shi said.

Xu Qingzhu paused slightly. "Our Teacher Liang is already too tired from running around every day. You're already working so hard to earn money and support the family. How could I make you run back and forth?"

Liang Shi: "?"

She felt like something was off about how Xu Qingzhu was talking.

"What's wrong?" Liang Shi broke apart the chopsticks and placed them in front of her, asking softly, "Did something happen?"

At that moment, Liang Shi was half-squatting in front of Xu Qingzhu, looking at her with very serious eyes.

Xu Qingzhu raised her hand and touched her hair. "Teacher Liang, won't you really consider letting me support you?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Footnotes:

¹ **Tsundere (傲娇):** A Japanese term commonly used in Chinese internet culture to describe someone who is initially cold, hostile, or aloof but gradually shows a warmer, friendlier side. The word combines "tsuntsun" (aloof) and "deredere" (lovestruck).

² **Golden Palm (金棕榈):** A reference to a prestigious film award. In the story's fictional context, this appears to be an important film festival award similar to real-world awards like the Palme d'Or at Cannes.